

Traffic & Lead Strategy — Whiteford Mountain West Colorado PI

Built on Alex Hormozi's acquisition frameworks and modern direct-response best practices — adapted to Colorado attorney-advertising rules and the post-SB26-174 landscape

v1.0 · Draft for Jeff's review · Companion to docs/01 (keywords) and docs/08 (completion report)

0. The strategic frame (why this works now)

The modern acquisition playbook (Hormozi and the broader direct-response school) points at one asset stack — and we already built most of it:

Framework concept	Our implementation
Lead magnet (a complete solution to one narrow problem)	Case-value estimator (diagnostic type) + Sky's instant phone intake
Intent-matched bridge pages	100 intent-matched landing pages, each a pre-frame bridge
Traffic you OWN	HighLevel list, tagged + attributed at the source
Follow-up funnel	HighLevel sequences (to build — Phase 1 below)
Value ladder	Estimator → consultation → representation (contingency)

The market timing thesis (from docs/01): SB26-174 makes third-party lead-selling a deceptive trade practice (~Aug 2026). Competitors who rent their pipeline from lead brokers lose supply. Every dollar below builds pipeline **we own**. Hard rule for this entire document: **no lead marketplaces, no per-lead purchases from third-party generators, no paid referral arrangements** (also barred by Colo. RPC 7.2). Firm-branded advertising only.

Honesty adaptations (important): These frameworks assume an info-product seller's freedom. A law firm cannot use manufactured scarcity, fake urgency, outcome promises, or "results-based certainty" claims. Every tactic below is filtered through Colo. RPC 7.1-7.3. Where a book tactic can't be used honestly, it's adapted or dropped and marked .

1. Unit economics — what "profitable" means here (do this math first)

The governing metric (per Hormozi): **LTGP:CAC $\geq$ 3:1** — lifetime gross profit at least 3× the cost to acquire. For contingency PI (assumptions to validate against firm data):

- Blended gross fee per signed case (mix of soft-tissue and serious): assume **\$10,000–\$15,000** conservative blended; serious cases far higher. Use **\$12,000** for planning.
 - Therefore **maximum allowable CAC per signed case $\approx$ \$4,000** (3:1 floor).
 - Typical funnel rates to plan against (industry-reasonable, must be measured): qualified lead → consultation $\approx$ 50–60% (Sky booking live raises this), consultation → signed $\approx$ 25–40%. So $\approx$ **6–8 qualified leads per signed case** → **target blended cost per qualified lead (CPL): $\leq$ \$500**, with organic channels pulling the blend far down.
 - **Cash-flow caveat (client-financed acquisition doesn't apply):** contingency fees arrive months/years after spend. Paid budget must be sized as patient capital — set a monthly ceiling you can carry for 12–18 months without revenue from it. This cash-timing reality is the single biggest adaptation required for contingency practice, and the reason organic-first sequencing matters.
 - Every channel below gets measured on **cost per signed case**, not per click or call. The attribution rails exist: UTMs + source page + keyword flow into HighLevel on every estimator submission and Sky call.
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2. The offer layer — fix this before buying traffic

Traffic multiplies the offer; it doesn't fix it (Hormozi's first law). "Free consultation" is what every competitor says. Rebuild the two front-end offers around the value drivers Hormozi popularized (↑ dream outcome, ↑ perceived likelihood, ↓ time, ↓ effort):

2a. The lead magnet (exists — sharpen the wrapper). Rename the estimator with reason-why naming, honestly: **"The Colorado Case Value Snapshot — a free 2-minute educational read on what drives cases like yours, under Colorado's new 2025 damages law."** Reason-why (2025 law change) + audience (Colorado) + outcome (know what drives value) + time (2 minutes) + a concrete container word (Snapshot). No manufactured download caps — scarcity is dropped for the magnet.

2b. The consultation (rename + stack). Not "free consultation" but the **"Colorado Claim Game Plan Session"** — 30 minutes, and the caller/visitor is told exactly what they leave with, each named (build once, deliver to every prospect): 1. A deadline check for their specific claim type (urgency that is *real* in PI — statutes of limitation — honest urgency, not manufactured) 2. An evidence-preservation checklist for their incident type

(from our content system) 3. A straight answer on whether the case justifies counsel — "if you'd do fine on your own, we'll say so" (differentiator; already site copy) 4. The insurance-conversation briefing (what recorded statements do) - **Guarantee (the strongest lever, and law-native)**: the contingency fee IS the implied guarantee — "*You pay no fee unless we recover for you.*" Lead with it everywhere (pending attorney confirmation of engagement practice + required disclaimers about costs vs. fees). - Dropped from the standard playbook: bonus stacking with dollar values, cohort scarcity, expiring pricing — inappropriate for legal services.

2c. The one core belief. One belief, repeated everywhere, that topples the rest: **"Insurers pay full value only to claimants they believe are prepared to go to trial — and preparation is exactly what a national trial platform provides from day one."** Every ad, page, email, and Sky's framing already align with this. Supporting false-belief content list (each gets a story-driven piece, not a lecture): "my case is too small to bother a lawyer" · "lawyers take most of the money" · "the insurer's first offer is close to fair" · "hiring a lawyer means suing and courtrooms" · "it's too late for me" · "all injury firms are billboard mills."

2d. The authority persona / movement. The authority persona is the *team story*: Jeff as the Denver-based leader (backstory: Colorado attorney who built the firm's Mountain West front door), Masten as the reformed insider — **"he spent years defending insurers; now he uses their playbook for injured people."** That conversion-story arc is our single best narrative asset. Movement slogan (campaign-sign simple): **"Coloradans shouldn't get discount justice."** All client-story content requires real, consented, non-identifying examples or none at all — no invented parables presented as real.

3. Funnel architecture — mapped to what's live

Traffic temperature → page mapping (already built, now explicit policy): - **Hot** (searching our name / repeat visitors): homepage, About, direct estimator. Short bridge. - **Warm** (searching the problem: "denver car accident lawyer"): the 100 landing pages ARE the pre-frame bridge layer — educate → estimator/call. This is why they're content-rich, not thin doorways. - **Cold** (interrupted on social/YouTube): NEVER send to the homepage. Send to dedicated long-bridge pages (to build): story-first structure, then the estimator. Phase-2 build: 3 cold bridge pages (car crash / serious injury / wrongful death).

The follow-up funnel (biggest current gap — Phase 1 priority). ~81% of conversions happen at contact 5+. Estimator and Sky both capture email + consent; today nothing systematic follows. Build in HighLevel: 1. **Story-driven intro sequence** (5 emails, days 0-5): (1) here's your snapshot + what it can't tell you → (2) Masten's insider story → (3) the epiphany: preparation changes outcomes + Game Plan Session offer → (4) hidden factors

(deadlines, evidence decay, comparative fault) → (5) honest urgency: *your* deadline clock is real → book/call CTA. Every email: attorney-advertising footer, unsubscribe, no outcome promises. 2. **Ongoing weekly cadence** (weekly, not daily — legal-appropriate): one story or Colorado-law development per week, each tying to the Session offer. Doubles as the content engine's email leg. 3. **Multichannel**: email + (with captured consent) SMS reminder for booked consultations + site-visitor retargeting audiences (\$5). 4. **Speed-to-lead**: estimator submissions with phone numbers get a Sky **outbound** follow-up call within 5 minutes during business hours (Retell outbound agent is already bound to the number). Outbound only to people who submitted contact info with consent — never cold calls, never solicitation of known accident victims.

4. Organic engines (Hormozi's four channels, adapted, with single-platform discipline)

4a. Owned search (already 80% built — finish the last mile). Submit sitemap to GSC (docs/07 steps); buy the brand domain (docs/02); build the backlink base with the free/legitimate layer: state bar directory, Avvo/Justia/FindLaw *profile listings* (profiles are fine; their paid lead-gen products are not), legal + local directories, Google Business Profile for the Denver office (reviews engine: post-matter review requests via HighLevel), local citations with the consistent new NAP. Monthly content cadence afterward: 4 new pieces/month aimed at cluster gaps GSC reveals (More → Better → New: expand what ranks before adding new clusters).

4b. Content engine (over-give, ask rarely; one platform mastered first). Legal demand is search-based, so the platform order is **YouTube → (repurpose) → everything else** — meet people where they already search: - **The master show**: one 10–15 min weekly video, Jeff (or Jeff+guest) on one false belief or one Colorado-law reality. Hook → story → offer structure; teach *what and why*, sell the *how* (the Session). Titles = our value-cluster keywords ("What's a Colorado car-accident case actually worth in 2026?"). - Chop each into: 3 Shorts/Reels, 1 landing-page embed (the matching cluster page gets the video — SEO dwell bonus), 1 weekly email, quote cards for GBP posts. - Give:ask ratio ≥ 3.5:1. CTA is always the Snapshot or the Session, never "hire us." - Volume discipline, adapted: **100 minutes/day** of content production/distribution effort across the team, 100 days, before judging results.

4c. The Colorado Target-100 (earned media only). Build the list of existing congregations of injured-or-adjacent Coloradans: Denver/CO Springs TV consumer-affairs segments, Colorado Sun/Denverite/Westword reporters on traffic-safety beats, CO personal-finance and outdoor-recreation podcasts, ski-community newsletters and forums, cycling clubs, neighborhood Facebook/Nextdoor groups, chiropractors/PT clinics/body

shops/tow operators (relationship + education only — **nothing of value exchanged for referrals**, RPC 7.2), CU/DU law-media, HOA newsletters. Relationship-first protocol: follow, engage, serve for 4–6 weeks before any ask; the "ask" is always educational (interview Jeff about the 2025 damages-cap change — genuinely newsworthy), never "send us clients." Expect ~10% to convert into earned placements; each placement gets retargeted (\$5) so no visit is wasted.

4d. Warm outreach (week 1, costs nothing). One personal announcement from Jeff to his full Colorado network (email + LinkedIn): the firm now handles injury matters statewide, here's the 2-minute Snapshot to share with anyone who gets hurt. To acquaintances as announcement — not targeted solicitation of anyone known to be injured. Repeat quarterly with a story, not an ask.

5. Paid engines — profitable and compliant (sequenced last, per Hormozi, but planned now)

Sequencing rule (Hormozi's ordering): paid comes last and scales what organic proves. Launch order below; each phase must hit its gate before the next opens. All ads are firm-branded, land on our own pages, and comply with RPC 7.1 (no outcome promises, no "best," dramatization labeled).

5a. Google Search PPC (first paid dollar — highest intent, provable). - Structure: exact/phrase campaigns mirroring our top-opportunity keyword clusters (docs/05). Start with the 15 value-cluster + Denver head terms. Ads land on the *matching* landing page (message match = quality score = cheaper clicks). - PI reality: Denver head-term CPCs run \$80–250+. The profitable wedge is **long-tail + educational angle**: "what is my case worth"-type queries cost a fraction and feed the Snapshot. Two campaign layers: (1) high-intent "lawyer/attorney" terms with call-focused ads (Sky answers 24/7 — a genuine conversion advantage over competitors' voicemail after 5pm), (2) value-intent terms driving the Snapshot at low CPC. - **Testing budget rule (adapted from Hormozi):** kill a keyword/ad after spending 2× the target CPL with zero qualified leads; 10× budget behind winners. Start: **\$3–5k/month**, gate to scale: blended paid CPL ≤ \$500 and ≥ 1 signed case attributable within 90 days. - Branded defense campaign ("whiteford injury") from day one — cheap insurance.

5b. Google Local Services Ads (attorney review required first). LSAs are Google's pay-per-lead product with "Google Screened" badging. Economically excellent for PI, **but** SB26-174 targets paying for leads — whether a platform's own ad format under the firm's name falls in scope is a legal question Jeff must answer before activation. Documented here; not activated.

5c. Meta (Facebook/Instagram) — retargeting first, cold second. - Retargeting (launch with 5a): site visitors + estimator starters who didn't finish + video viewers.

Small budget (\$500–1,000/mo), high efficiency; creative = the false-belief series and the courtroom film cut (label: dramatization). Frequency caps + sensitivity: injury audiences get educational tone, never "were you injured?" callouts (avoids solicitation optics and Meta policy friction). - **Cold interruption (only after 4b produces proven hooks):** hook-story-offer creative tested organically first; CO-geo, broad targeting; goal = Snapshot completions, not clicks. Gate: paid CPL from Meta $\leq 2 \times$ Google's before scaling. - **Target-100 leverage:** run ads to followers/engagers of the Colorado congregations from 4c where targeting allows.

5d. YouTube pre-roll (after 4b's channel exists): :15/:30 cuts of the master show + film, targeting CO + in-market/legal-services + crash-related search behavior. Cheap CPMs, feeds retargeting pools, builds the omnipresence effect for everyone who touched the site.

5e. Explicitly excluded: third-party lead marketplaces, per-lead brokers, "partner" firms selling cases, paid referral deals, review-buying, billboard/TV (revisit at >\$50k/mo digital spend). Radio/OTT: later, only with dedicated tracking numbers.

Budget arc (patient capital, monthly): Months 1–2: \$0 paid (organic + follow-up funnel build). Months 3–4: \$4–6k (5a + retargeting). Months 5–6: \$8–12k if gates pass. Month 7+: scale winners toward the \$4k/signed-case ceiling, in strict order: more budget on winners → fix the worst funnel step → only then new channels.

6. Measurement (what gets reviewed weekly)

One dashboard (HighLevel + GSC + ads): sessions by cluster · Snapshot starts/completions (rate) · Sky calls + booked Sessions (Sky's analysis fields already capture how-found-us) · qualified leads by source (UTM→HL is live) · consultations held · signed cases by source · CPL and cost/signed by channel · LTGP:CAC rolling quarter. Weekly kill/scale decisions on paid; monthly more→better→new review on everything. Add: call-tracking numbers per paid channel (keep NAP number consistent for SEO — tracking numbers only on ads/landing params, never in schema).

7. 90-day rollout

- **Weeks 1–2:** GSC submission · GBP setup + review engine · warm-outreach announcement · story-driven intro sequence live in HighLevel · Sky outbound speed-to-lead on · brand domain decision.

- **Weeks 3-6:** Master show launches (weekly, forever) · directory/profile layer · Target-100 list built + engagement begun · 3 cold bridge pages built · false-belief email cadence begins.
- **Weeks 7-10:** Google PPC layer-2 (value terms) + branded + retargeting live · first earned-media pitches (2025 cap-change angle) · LSA legal review decision.
- **Weeks 11-13:** PPC layer-1 (high-intent) if CPL gate passed · first paid-channel kill/scale review · quarterly report against \$1 economics.

8. Attorney-review gate (before any paid spend)

1. Contingency/"no fee unless we recover" phrasing + costs disclosure.
2. LSA vs. SB26-174 scope.
3. Dramatization labeling on film in ad contexts.
4. Email/SMS sequences (advertising footers, consent, opt-out).
5. Sky outbound follow-up call script.
6. Review-request flow (no incentivized reviews).
7. All \$2 offer names and claims.

Framework basis: Alex Hormozi's acquisition methodology and related modern direct-response practice — applied, adapted, and where necessary overridden for Colo. RPC 7.1–7.3 and SB26-174 compliance. Nothing in this document authorizes outcome promises, manufactured scarcity, purchased leads, or paid referrals.